

The Washington Post

Prices may vary in areas outside metropolitan Washington.

RE V1 V2 V3 V4



Mostly cloudy 76/65 • Tomorrow: Mostly sunny 85/66 **B18**

Democracy Dies in Darkness

THURSDAY, AUGUST 21, 2025 • \$4

Putin had a good hand. Then it got overplayed.

His hard-line approach at Alaska summit doesn't align with Trump's goals

BY ROBYN DIXON, CATHERINE BELTON AND FRANCESCA EBEL

The dueling summits over the fate of Ukraine held in Anchorage and then Washington over the last few days yielded dramatically contrasting results for Russian President Vladimir Putin, indicating — at least for now — he overplayed his hand in attempting to woo the United States to his view of the conflict.

Despite the opportunity for a peace deal, Putin's resistance to compromise and his potentially misplaced confidence in a military victory over Ukraine risked missing the chance to capitalize on his warm vibe with President Donald Trump, while dragging out a war that is killing thousands every week and undermining Russia's economy and its global strategic position.

Since the summits, Russia has continued to throw obstacles in the way of any measures recommended to advance the process, suggesting Putin is not willing to move at the same pace as Trump. On Wednesday, Russian Foreign Minister Sergei Lavrov made clear that Russia expects to have a veto over any security arrangements Europe and the U.S. come up with to defend Ukraine from future attacks.

The risks are still growing over Putin's recalcitrance. "Putin

SEE PUTIN ON A10

Moscow balks: Limits of diplomacy clear as Kremlin barely budes. **A10**

Week 2 of Trump's law enforcement takeover in D.C.



JOSE LUIS GONZALEZ/REUTERS

Metro Transit Police officers interview people at an Anacostia bus stop Wednesday. National Guard personnel and federal agents have been working alongside police as part of President Donald Trump's push to curb crime in D.C.

D.C. restaurants suffer amid federal crackdown

BY TIM CARMAN AND WARREN ROJAS

Since President Donald Trump announced his takeover of the D.C. police force last week, restaurant reservations have dropped in the city by as much as 31 percent year over year for a single day, according to restaurant booking data. Business owners are concerned that the continued surge in law enforcement could impact their revenue during a vital period of the summer.

Owners report drop in reservations, absent staff during vital summer era

Several operators say the decline does not bode well for them or the 380 establishments participating in Summer Restaurant Week, which started Monday in the greater D.C. area. The bargain-dining promotion is consid-

ered a lifeline for restaurants hoping to survive the doldrums of August, when Congress is on recess, locals are on vacation and many local residents are gearing up for back-to-school season. One of the goals with the promotion, says Shawn Townsend, president and chief executive of the Restaurant Association Metropolitan Washington, is to help the industry make it to Labor Day, when D.C. springs back to life.

This August has been particularly tough on D.C. restaurants,

numerous operators told The Washington Post. They were already dealing with a number of destabilizing issues — rising labor and ingredient costs, soaring rents, federal worker layoffs, U.S. Immigration and Customs Enforcement audits — when the president announced last week that he was sending in troops and federal agents to deal with a city

SEE RESTAURANTS ON A13

Vance: Vice president says D.C. could be model for other cities. **B14**

DOJ demands sweeping info on care for trans minors

BY CASEY PARKS AND DAVID OVALLE

The Justice Department is demanding that hospitals turn over a wide range of sensitive information related to medical care for young transgender patients, including billing documents, communication with drug manufacturers and data such as patient dates of birth, Social Security numbers and addresses, according to a copy of a subpoena made public in a court filing this week.

The June subpoena to Children's Hospital of Philadelphia requests emails, Zoom recordings, "every writing or record of whatever type" doctors have made, voicemails and text messages on encrypted platforms dating to January 2020 — before hormone therapy, puberty blockers and gender transition surgery had been banned anywhere in the United States.

About half of states have since passed laws prohibiting all or most gender treatment of minors. The Supreme Court ruled in June that a Tennessee ban did not violate the Constitution.

Attorney General Pam Bondi said last month that the Justice Department had issued more than 20 subpoenas seeking to hold "medical professionals and organizations that mutilated children

SEE INFORMATION ON A7



REUTERS

People rescue a Palestinian woman, Saja Hamad, who was trapped Wednesday under the rubble of a house that was hit in an Israeli strike in Nuseirat in the central Gaza Strip.

Hamas signals new willingness to compromise

BY CLAIRE PARKER, SIHAM SHAMALAKH AND HEBBA FAROUK MAHFOUZ

JERUSALEM — The decision this week by Hamas to accept a proposed ceasefire deal with Israel comes amid heightened pressure on the group from Arab governments and other Palestinian factions, which are eager to avert a planned Israeli invasion of Gaza City.

Hamas announced Monday that it had signed off on a new ceasefire agreement, following a flurry of diplomacy in Egypt, where Qatari and Egyptian mediators huddled with Hamas representatives in recent days. The Israeli government, which voted this month to expand the war and occupy more of Gaza, has yet to agree to the proposal.

In a significant develop-

ment, Arab countries last month came out publicly for the first time in favor of disarming Hamas, a key Israeli demand. Arab officials attending a U.N. conference endorsed disarmament if it came in the context of an end to the 22-month war and movement

SEE HAMAS ON A11

State: Press officer fired after disputes over Gaza copy style. **A9**

Most D.C. residents oppose takeover of police, poll finds

Strong disagreement with Trump's rhetoric of a city overrun by crime

BY JOE HEIM, SCOTT CLEMENT AND EMILY GUSKIN

Washington, D.C., residents overwhelmingly oppose President Donald Trump's decision last week to take over the D.C. police and order federal law enforcement and the National Guard onto District streets, and 65 percent don't think his actions will make the city safer from violent crime, according to a Washington Post-Schar School poll.

Thirty-one percent of District residents say crime is an "extremely" or "very" serious problem in the city, down from 50 percent in May and 65 percent in spring 2024. While the latest poll

finds strong opposition to several tactics Trump has employed, residents show some agreement on one view: Just under half think increasing punishments for convicted teenagers would reduce violent crime.

The vast majority of residents, though, don't want Trump controlling law enforcement efforts in the city. About 8 in 10 D.C. residents oppose Trump's executive order to federalize law enforcement in the city, with about 7 in 10 opposing it "strongly."

Residents of the District, where Trump won just 6 percent of the vote in the 2024 election, disagree with the president's many characterizations of the city as overrun by crime. On Monday, Trump said Washington had been "the most unsafe place anywhere," but 78 percent of residents say they feel very or somewhat safe in their neighborhoods. This is similar to 76 percent in May, but the percentage who feel "very safe" is up

SEE POLL ON A14

About 8 in 10 Washingtonians oppose Trump taking control of D.C.'s police and deploying federal troops

Q: Do you support or oppose Trump ordering the federal government to take control of D.C.'s police department and ordering the National Guard and FBI to patrol D.C.?

Strongly support Somewhat support No opinion
Somewhat oppose Strongly oppose



Source: Aug. 14-17, 2025, Washington Post-Schar School poll of 604 D.C. residents with an error margin of +/- 4.1 percentage points.

IN THE NEWS

Kilmar Abrego García case Lawyers for the illegally deported man are seeking the dismissal of his human smuggling case, calling it a vindictive prosecution. **B13**

At the White House Public tours have been suspended indefinitely because of the planned construction of a massive ballroom. **B13**

THE NATION The security clearances of 37 people were revoked by the director of national intelligence. **A2**
The president called for a Fed governor to resign, in his latest bid to sway the central bank. **A3**

THE WORLD A massacre in the Democratic Republic of Congo follows U.S. peace efforts there. **A8**
Pope Leo may visit Lebanon on his first overseas trip as pontiff, Catholic officials say. **A11**

THE ECONOMY Reading for pleasure among U.S. adults has fallen 40 percent in the past 20 years as attention spans wither. **A12**

THE CLIMATE City "food forests" allow residents to harvest fresh produce, while also having environmental benefits. **A18**

STYLE With 2000s fashion back in style, two millennials went to the mall to see if they could pull off their old looks. **B1**

SPORTS Terry McLaurin is healthy and "closer" to returning as he seeks a contract extension, Dan Quinn says. **B7**

THE REGION Virginia Wesleyan University will be renamed to Batten University in honor of a longtime benefactor. **B13**

LOCAL LIVING The best blue paint colors, according to design pros. From sapphire to cerulean, these blues will dress up any space.

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